

and industrial growth but only temporarily, as the Union economy emerged stronger from the conflict. The greatest lingering costs were the pensions to hundreds of thousands of veterans, totaling 40 percent of the Federal budget in the 1890s.

 **850,000** **The estimated number of soldiers who entered the Confederate military. The First Conscription Act was passed in 1862.**

The new nation

A key legacy was a new American nationalism in which the Union was deemed perpetual. Symbolically, the name “The United States” became a singular noun and a stronger national government came forth. In wartime, the nation had instituted compulsory national conscription, direct federal income tax, greenback (paper) currency, and a suspension of civil liberties. In support of these powers, Republicans had worked to fashion a new sense of patriotism emphasizing unconditional loyalty to the government.

Though many expanded authorities faded during peacetime, the precedent of national administration remained. To ease reconciliation, the Union government conducted no treason trials. In May 1865, Jefferson Davis was imprisoned for two years in Fort Monroe, Virginia, but released without trial. General Robert E. Lee was never arrested. The only high-profile case was that of Captain Henry Wirz. The commander of Andersonville Prison, Wirz was hanged on November 10, 1865, for crimes of mismanagement. Union soldiers at his execution chanted, “Wirz, remember Andersonville.”

Most Confederates were ultimately restored to rights by the end of Reconstruction. However, postwar Republican dominance did have other consequences. One was Southern political and economic marginalization. Another was the United States’ entry into an expansive era of industrial growth with little government oversight, famously described by Mark Twain as the “Gilded Age.”